

NOUN CLAUSE

A noun clause is a group of words that acts as a noun in a sentence. It has a subject and a verb but does not express a complete thought on its own.

* Key Features:

1. Functions as a noun
2. Contains a subject and predicate
3. Usually begins with words like that, what, who, whom, whose, which, when, where, why, how, if, whether

* Functions of a Noun Clause:

1. As a Subject

What she said is true.

(Here, "What she said" is the subject)

2. As an Object of a Verb

I know that he is honest.

("that he is honest" is the object of "know")

3. As an Object of a Preposition

She is worried about what will happen.

4. As a Subject Complement

The problem is that we are late.

Examples:

I don't understand why he left.

Whoever comes first will win the prize.

Tell me what you want.

* Simple Tip:

If you can replace the clause with a single noun (like something), it's likely a noun clause.

Example:

I know that he is right → I know this.

EXERCISE

Identify the noun clause in each sentence and state its function.

1. I know that she is hardworking.
2. What he said surprised everyone.
3. We are thinking about where to spend the holiday.
4. The truth is that he lied to us.
5. Whoever wins the match will receive a prize.
6. She asked whether I was ready.
7. I cannot imagine how they escaped.
8. What you need is confidence.

